

DPSH MUN 2026

FIFA

Where Strategy Meets the Beautiful Game.

**INTERNATIONAL FOOTBALL
FEDERATION**



Table of Contents

1. Letter from the Executive Board
 2. Introduction to the Agenda
 3. Historical Incidents
 4. International Frameworks & FIFA measures
 5. Key Weaknesses
 6. Goals of the Committee
 7. Guiding Questions
 8. Recommended Solutions
 9. Suggested Research Links
- 

Letter from the Executive Board

Dear Delegates,

We welcome you to DPSH MUN 26'. As your Executive Board for the FIFA committee, our goal is to provide a solid foundational background for your research and debate on the agenda. We encourage thorough research beyond this guide and to come prepared with insightful positions reflecting your assigned country's policies. This background guide provides a solid foundation but does not replace your own research. Prepare to think critically and engage thoughtfully with the agenda.

FIFA governs one of the world's most beloved sports but faces ongoing challenges around integrity, including match-fixing, bribery, and corruption. This committee's work is critical to shape compliance mechanisms that uphold fairness while ensuring transparent and accountable governance.

We look forward to a productive and engaging conference with respectful and constructive dialogue.

Best regards,

Vrishin - Chairperson Harsha - Chairperson

Introduction to The Agenda

Agenda : Developing a comprehensive FIFA compliance and monitoring mechanism to prevent match-fixing, bribery, and corruption in football worldwide that promotes transparency and accountability.

Football is known as the World's Game. Due to that, its popularity demands firm integrity standards. Challenges such as match-fixing, bribery, and high-profile corruption actively continue to threaten FIFA's policies, its mission, and its trust as a global sport for all. While recent compliance programmes and integrity measures mark progress, there are still major vulnerabilities in transparency, enforcement, and capacity all around the globe. This agenda seeks a universally binding, transparent FIFA compliance and monitoring mechanism against unethical practices.

Historical Incidents:

2015 FIFA Corruption Scandal:

The 2015 scandal remains the largest anti-corruption action in global football history. In May 2015, United States and Swiss prosecutors indicted fourteen top FIFA officials and sports marketing executives for wire fraud, racketeering, and an elaborate money laundering operation spanning two decades. The charges detailed how these officials solicited and accepted more than \$150 million in bribes and kickbacks for media, marketing, and hosting rights, including selections for the FIFA World Cup and other major tournaments. The coordinated global investigation involved arrests in Switzerland (where seven FIFA executives were detained while preparing for the FIFA Congress), raids on CONCACAF's headquarters in the U.S., and separate criminal investigations in Australia, Germany, Costa Rica, and Colombia. Guilty pleas, resignations, and convictions followed, revealing a deep institutional culture of corruption at the heart of FIFA's leadership and catalyzing sweeping reforms though scrutiny continues over their effectiveness.

Columbia Law Journal Analysis of FIFA Corruption (2024):

Scholarly research published by the Columbia Law School highlights the systemic weaknesses within FIFA's

governance structure that foster repeated episodes of bribery, corruption, and failure to uphold compliance standards. It critically analyzes the organizational, ethical, and legal challenges FIFA faces and offers

recommendations for comprehensive institutional reform.

The research underscores the global risks posed by FIFA's compliance deficiencies and informs best practices for new regulatory mechanisms in football governance.

Negreira Case (Spain, 2023–2024, ongoing):

The Negreira case involves multi-million euro payments made by FC Barcelona to former referee official José María Enríquez Negreira. The Barcelona Court dismissed specific bribery charges in May 2024 based on legal interpretations concerning the status of Negreira as a public official.

Nonetheless, broader investigations into sports corruption and money laundering continue, leaving the case unresolved.

No definitive judicial conclusion has established this as a corruption scandal; pending legal outcomes prevent conclusive characterization.

Major Match-Fixing and Illegal Betting Cases:

Match-fixing and illegal betting scandals are persistent threats across international and national football tournaments. Historic examples include Italy's Calciopoli case, resulting in Juventus' relegation and bans for club officials following revelations of systematically influencing referees, and recent lifetime bans for numerous players and officials in China following extensive investigations of match-fixing. Global law enforcement and sports oversight bodies remain vigilant, but the challenges posed by illicit gambling and corruption continue to evolve.

International Frameworks & FIFA Measures.

Compliance Programs : Risk assessments, audit committees, data transparency, independent oversight, and reporting mandates.

Code of Ethics & Integrity Workshops: Sanctions for match manipulation, bribery, and betting fraud.

UN Guidelines & ILO Conventions: Demanding transparent, accountable, and remedy-oriented anti-corruption efforts.

Key Weaknesses:

Mixed enforcement across member states.

Reluctance to publish penalties and findings.

Limitations in independence and resources for compliance bodies.

Difficulty detecting complex corruption schemes.

Goals Of The Committee:

Build robust, globally enforceable compliance and monitoring standards for all FIFA events and member countries.

Institutionalize anti-corruption, anti-match-fixing, and anti-bribery mandates with binding force.

Learn directly from the Negreira case and Columbia Law analysis by:

Creating mandatory independent review panels for all referee-related contracts and club-official interactions. Implementing transparent financial disclosure policies for all clubs and officials.

Structuring reporting channels for suspected corruption. Ensuring equal oversight capacity for small and large member nations.

Develop proactive tools based on international best practices for detecting, deterring, and punishing unfair conduct .

Engage civil society and affected groups to improve grassroots monitoring and early warning systems.

Guiding Questions.

1. What independent compliance structures can prevent referee and official conflicts of interest?
2. How should FIFA incentivize whistleblowing and protect informants?
3. Which legal and technological tools are most effective for uncovering covert bribery?
4. What sanctions and remedies offer real deterrence for future cases?

Recommended Solutions:

Establish a global Football Integrity Compliance Centre with special authority for referee contracts and club spending reviews.

Demand previous and post-event integrity training, real-time monitoring, and public reporting for every national association and club.

Institute standardized sanctions, public investigations, and direct access mechanisms for whistleblowers. Promote equal representation and empower small countries in compliance decision-making.

Use findings from major cases like Negreira and research-based recommendations for continuous improvement.

Suggested Research Links:

[ESPN - The Negreria Case](#)

[Mess Que Un Club: Barça and the Negreira Case – Columbia Law Journal](#)

[SSRN – FIFA Corruption Research](#)

[FIFA Integrity Programme](#)

[Transparency International – Football Governance](#)

[Agents FC – Persistent Match Fixing](#)